

JAHANGIRNAGAR UNIVERSITY

DEPARTMENT OF ENGLISH

BA (HONOURS) 4TH YEAR FINAL EXAMINATION QUESTION BANK

COURSE CODE: E 404

COURSE TITLE: Sociolinguistics

Target Stream: Concentration on Applied Linguistics & ELT

Batches Included: 42, 43, 44, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50 (Batch 45 missing)

CURRENT SYLLABUS REFERENCE & SCOPE (Session: 2021–2022, Batch 51)

SYLLABUS TOPICS:

- **Scope & Concepts:** Definition and scope; Sociolinguistics vs. Sociology of Language; Micro vs. Macro sociolinguistics.
- **Language & Dialect:** Standard language; Bell's seven criteria; Dialect; Language standardization process & challenges.
- **Contact Languages:** Pidgin & pidginization; Creole & creolization; Post-creole continuum; Decreolization.
- **Linguistic Geography:** Wave theory vs. Tree model; Isogloss; Dialect boundaries.
- **Multilingualism:** Diglossia vs. Bilingualism; High (H) and Low (L) varieties; Polyglossia; Types of bilingualism.
- **Language Contact Phenomena:** Code-switching (CS) and Code-mixing; Types and meta-principles of CS; Borrowing; Translanguaging.
- **Language Planning & Policy:** Corpus, status, and acquisition planning; Early Language Planning (ELP) vs. Critical Language Policy (CLP; Tollefson); Cobarrubias' ideologies; Cooper (1989).
- **Language Variation & Change (LVC):** Variationist sociolinguistics; Social factors (class, age, ethnicity, social networks).
- **Language & Culture:** Sapir-Whorf Hypothesis (linguistic determinism & relativity); Stuart Hall's 'Circuit of Culture' & representation.
- **Language & Gender:** Sexist ideology; Gender-neutral language; Dominance approach vs. Difference theory (Robin Lakoff, Deborah Tannen).
- **Linguistic Imperialism & Ecology:** Linguistic imperialism (Phillipson); Minority languages; Language shift, death, loss, and revitalization/rejuvenation.

SECTION A: BROAD ESSAY QUESTIONS

Comprehensive analytical essay questions from past examinations, organized thematically according to syllabus modules.

1. Scope, Concepts & Linguistic Geography

1. How is sociolinguistics different from the sociology of language? Give an account of the major areas of study that sociolinguistics is concerned with. [49, 47, 46, 44, 42]
2. How is language and society intertwined? Write an exploratory note on the sociological approaches to language studies. [48]
3. What is variationist sociolinguistics? Explicate the contributions of variationist sociolinguists in the study of Language Variation and Change (LVC). [50]
4. What model of linguistic innovation attracts you most (Tree Model vs. Wave Model)? Give an analytic argument in favour of your preference. [48]
5. What is an isogloss? What advantages does the wave theory have in explaining the birth and spread of a language variety? [46]
6. Differentiate between micro-sociolinguistics and macro-sociolinguistics. [42]

2. Standard Language, Dialect & Standardization

1. What is a standard language? Illuminate the process of standardization with a special focus on the possible challenges in the successive phases (Selection, Codification, Elaboration, Acceptance). [49, 48, 47, 46, 44, 43, 42]
2. Discuss Bell's seven criteria for standard languages with appropriate examples. [46, 43]
3. What varieties of language are defined according to 'use' (register, genre, style) and 'user' (dialect, sociolect, idiolect)? How is a dialect transformed into a national variety? [43]

3. Pidgins, Creoles & Language Contact

1. Differentiate between creole and pidgin. Discuss the different stages in the process of creolization and decreolization. [50, 48, 47, 46, 43, 42]
2. What are the key features of a pidgin language? Discuss the active tenets available in a post-creole continuum (Basilect, Mesolect, Acrolect). [49, 48]

4. Bilingualism, Diglossia & Code-Switching

1. What is diglossia, and how does it differ from bilingualism? What are the key features that distinguish the "High" (H) and "Low" (L) varieties in a diglossic situation? Can you provide real-life examples of diglossic communities? [50, 49, 44, 42]
2. Name the different types of code-switching (tag, inter-sentential, intra-sentential) with examples. Discuss how the meta-principles of CS bring about semantic constructions in bilingual discourses. [50]
3. What is code-switching (CS)? Discuss the five meta-principles and their significance in understanding CS in various communicative contexts. [48]
4. What kind of code-switching and code-mixing is prevalent in our daily use of language? Is code-switching threatening for our mother language? Discuss. [49, 47, 44, 42]
5. Define polyglossia. What does a polyglossic situation involve? Do you find any diglossic or polyglossic situation in Bangladesh? [43]

5. Language Planning, Policy & Linguistic Imperialism

1. "Defining language planning in terms of macro-sociological activities alone is an error" — discuss, with reference to the study, innovation, and proposition by Cooper (1989) and Pennycook (2002). [50]
2. The exclusion of ideological and sociopolitical realities of powerful groups in early language planning and policy (ELP) accelerated critical language planning and policy (CLP). Discuss with reference to features of ELP and Tollefson's (1991) approaches. [49, 48]
3. What is language planning? Describe the types of planning (Corpus, Status, Acquisition) with examples. How do the ideologies of Cobarrubias motivate linguists for language planning? [47, 43, 42]
4. What are the cultural consequences of linguistic imperialism? How does linguistic imperialism impact indigenous and minority languages? [50]
5. What are the factors that contribute to language shifting? Discuss the steps of 'language revitalization' and 'language loss / death'. [46, 44, 43, 42]

6. Language, Culture & Gender

1. What are the basic tenets of the Sapir-Whorf hypothesis? Discuss them with special reference to linguistic determinism, linguistic relativity, and the semantic, social, and behavioral aspects of language. [50, 49, 48, 47, 43]
2. Substantiate that gender-differentiated language is the product of the sexist ideology of patriarchal society. How can we ensure gender-neutral language usage in sociocultural and academic spaces? [50, 49]
3. Discuss, with examples, how social factors such as gender and social class are reflected in everyday language use. [48]
4. How do men and women use speech differently? Discuss the 'Dominance Approach' and 'Difference Theory' in relation to gender and language studies (referencing Robin Lakoff and Deborah Tannen). [47, 46, 44, 43, 42]
5. Can language be affected by culture? Describe Stuart Hall's 'Circuit of Culture' with examples. [46, 44]

SECTION B: SHORT NOTES & CONCISE SOCIOLINGUISTIC CONCEPTS

Short notes covering definitions, terminology, and specific sociolinguistic phenomena.

Short Notes Collection

1. The process of language standardization [50, 46]
2. The Tree-model vs. Wave-model of linguistic innovation [50]
3. Linguistic assimilation [50, 46]
4. Compound bilingualism vs. Coordinate bilingualism [50]
5. Linguistic imperialism [49]
6. Corpus planning vs. Status planning [49]
7. Regional varieties of language (Dialects) [49, 48]
8. Isogloss [49, 47, 44]
9. The post-creole continuum (Acrolect, Mesolect, Basilect) [48]
10. Geographical approaches to language studies [48]
11. Regional and social dialects (Sociolects) [48]
12. Bilingualism [48]
13. Vernacularization [47, 44]
14. Lingua Franca [47]
15. Consecutive bilingualism [46]
16. Patois [46]
17. Translanguaging [44]
18. De facto norms vs. De jure norms [44]
19. Butler English [44, 43]
20. Linguistic relativity [43, 42]
21. Edward Sapir [43]
22. Code-switching [43]
23. A diglossic situation [43]
24. Stuart Hall's Circuit of Culture [42]
25. Sociology of language [42]